

## What to look for in the spec-sheet

Being the most sophisticated part of the PC, you will need to be extra careful when selecting a motherboard. Remember the rule: “when in doubt about the configuration of a board, you should always refer to the manufacturer’s website and not an e-commerce site”.

We have already established the fact that Processor’s slot and RAM specifications are important because you cannot use a kind which wasn’t built for the board. Make sure that they are compatible before you buy. Motherboards mention the supported slots in the spec-sheet and so do the CPU manufacturers. Remember that the match must be exact – e.g. LGA1155 and LGA1156 are different. A processor which supports LGA1155 will NOT FIT in a LGA1156. Do not be tricked into thinking that the numbering you saw on the spec-sheet was probably a mistake or that you can somehow make them work together (you just can’t). We recommend you go to the manufacturer’s website and check for yourself when in doubt rather than trusting any random blog post you find on the web.

It is also important to remember that you must never try to force the CPU into the motherboard. The CPU does not fit from all sides. It has a specific orientation with which it goes into the board. Refer to manual when in doubt. Trying to force the CPU into the socket on the motherboard is the easiest way to bend or break one or more pins on the CPU’s rear. Such a damage is normally not covered under warranty and you will end up wasting the money you spent on the processor

Just like with CPU, make sure you have the right kind of RAM. Again, RAM modules go into their slots only in a single orientation. Never try to shove them in forcefully. You might break the RAM or the board or both. Read the specs carefully before buying and stay attentive when assembling.

Take notice for the display ports available at the back. If you do not want to buy a discreet graphics card, choose one which already has a display port (VGA/HDMI). We warn you, for it is easy to commit this mistake in greed of building a upgradeable CPU with a good motherboard (which does not have a built-in display port) but failing in the first step of building one.

If you want to have a truly upgradeable machine on the graphics front, make sure the board has more than one PCIe-x16 slot allowing you to SLI/ CrossFire two cards later. The card too will have to support those technologies too. Look out for the number of SATA/USB ports and on-board extension pins supported for front panel. They will matter when you need to attach more devices. While most motherboards come with USB 3 support,